a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

GRADE 6 · CURRICULUM BOOK

The Year, in One Place

Big ideas, year-at-a-glance, vocabulary, and the project arc.

Year theme: Businesses Need Systems and Roles

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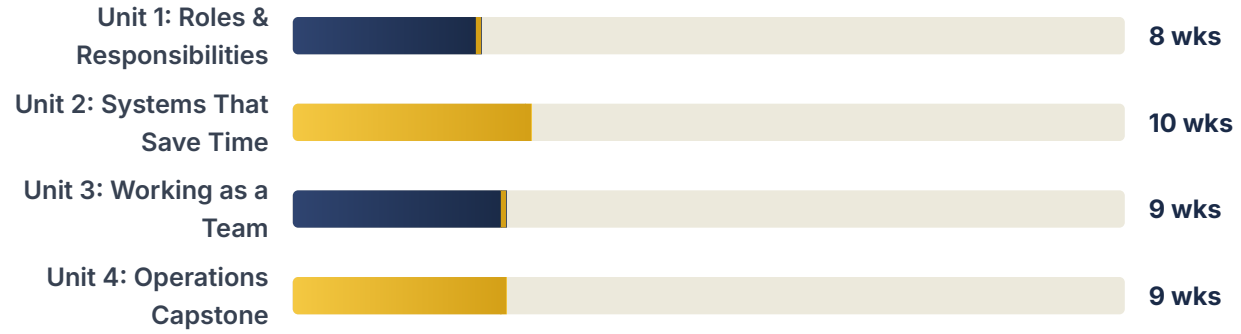
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.

WEEKS PER UNIT · GRADE 6



Each unit closes with a checkpoint artifact. Final defense in Week 36.

36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 6 · CURRICULUM BOOK

The Year, in One Place

Most adults run their lives without a system. You won't.

Year theme: Businesses need systems and roles **Grade band:** 6-8 (middle school — first year) **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 90–120 minutes per week (one block + one short follow-up) **Anchor mascot:** Cash, the program's animated host

Why this year

"Listening is not a moment. It's a system."

— CASH

Sixth graders are crossing a bridge. They are leaving the elementary band — where a "business" was a poster, a price, and a smile — and entering the middle-school band, where a business has a customer, a number, a process, and a name on every job. Grade 6 is the year that bridge gets built, plank by plank.

The shift is hard to overstate. In Grade 5 students learned that pricing is a choice with consequences and that profit is "what's left after costs." That work earned them the right to say "I sold ten cups." Grade 6 asks the next, harder questions: Who exactly were those ten people? Who restocked the lemonade while you sold? Who decides the price next time? What happens when something breaks? Without systems and roles, even a great idea collapses on its second Saturday.

The operations spine of the year is the **Standard Operating Procedure** — a written, step-by-step recipe for how a business does the same thing the same way every time. SOPs sound boring; they are not. They are how a 12-year-old goes from "I made one bracelet" to "my friend can make one bracelet exactly like mine while I do the math." SOPs are how small businesses scale without breaking.

The leadership spine is the **RACI chart** — a four-box tool that names, for every task, who's Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed. RACI is how teams stop arguing about whose job something was. It is also how 6th graders learn that "the boss" and "the worker" from Grade 2's classroom skits are not the only roles in a real business.

The financial spine is the **monthly ledger with a savings rate**. Students build a one-month income/expense tracker for a hypothetical 12-year-old's small business and set a savings target as a percentage of income. The math is sixth-grade math — ratios, rates, percentages — applied to a real-feeling situation. The Master Scope phrasing is "for a hypothetical 12-year-old's small business" on purpose: nobody is asked to share how their family handles money.

The thinking spine is the **5 Whys**. When a small business has a bad day — fewer sales, a customer complaint, a missed deadline — most kids stop at the first answer ("nobody came"). The 5 Whys forces them past surface causes to a possible root cause. Five rounds of "why" usually gets you somewhere useful.

These four — SOPs, RACI, ledgers, and 5 Whys — are the systems-and-roles toolkit. By June, every student should be able to use all four on a venture they care about.

The big ideas (Understanding by Design — Stage 1)

These are full-sentence understandings the year is built around. Every unit, lesson, and assessment can be traced back to one or more of these.

1. **A business is a system before it's a brand.** The logo is fun. The system is what runs when nobody's watching.
2. **Roles are how teams stop arguing about whose job it was.** A four-box RACI chart prevents more conflicts than any team-building game.
3. **The same thing, the same way, every time — that's an SOP.** Consistency is what turns one good day into a hundred good days.
4. **Customers come in segments, not as a crowd.** "Kids" is not a customer. "Sixth graders who walk to school and forget breakfast on game days" is closer.
5. **Numbers tell you what happened; ratios tell you whether it's working.** A monthly ledger with a savings rate is the smallest real budget in the program.
6. **The first answer is rarely the real answer.** The 5 Whys is how you get past it.
7. **Some things are legal but sketchy. The line is yours to draw — with reasons.** Ethics is judgment under uncertainty, not a rulebook.
8. **A weekly stand-up is the simplest improvement system there is.** Did → Doing → Stuck, repeated, is enough.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

- Who does what, on this team, when?
- What's the same every time we do this — and what's different?
- Which people, and how do you know?
- When something goes wrong, what's the real reason — not the obvious one?
- What does each customer in our segment have in common, and what makes them different from someone we're not selling to?
- What's a savings rate, and why would a 12-year-old's business want one?
- Where's the line between clever and sketchy — and how do I defend my call?

The eight strand outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

Grade 6 is the seventh row of the Cash to Company K-12 grid. Every cell below is a specific, measurable outcome a student can demonstrably do by year's end. These are quoted exactly from the Master Scope and Sequence — never paraphrased.

- **BAVC.** I can map a business's "value chain" — supplier → producer → seller → customer — for one real business with at least one example at each stage.
- **PSIG.** I can use the "5 Whys" technique on a business problem (e.g., "we sold less today") to find a possible root cause, written out.
- **MFL.** I can build a one-month income/expense ledger for a hypothetical 12-year-old's small business with a savings rate goal expressed as a percentage.
- **CBM.** I can identify the customer "segment" my product serves and describe at least 3 things I know about that segment (age, where they hang out, what they care about).
- **OSO.** I can write a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for a 5-step process in my business (e.g., "how to take an order") with checks for each step.
- **LTO.** I can fill out a RACI chart (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) for a 4-task project with a 4-person team.
- **ESL.** I can identify whether a business action is "legal but sketchy," "fully fine," or "over the line" using 3 example cases, and defend my call.
- **LRCI.** I can run a weekly "stand-up" review with 3 prompts (Did → Doing → Stuck) for two consecutive weeks and adjust my plan once.

Each unit braids 3–4 strands. Unit 1 anchors BAVC and CBM with supporting beams from PSIG. Unit 2 centers MFL and OSO with BAVC. Unit 3 centers LTO and OSO with ESL. Unit 4 centers LRCI and PSIG with all of the above pulled forward into the year-end Capstone defense.

Year-at-a-glance

The year is built as four units. Each unit ends with a public-facing artifact and feeds the rolling Capstone — the Systems-and-Roles Venture — that students design across the year.

Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor artifact
1	1–8	Where the value comes from	A business is a value chain, not just a storefront.	A Value Chain Map: supplier → producer → seller → customer for one real business, plus a Segment Sketch for the student's own venture.
2	9–18	Build the system		

Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor artifact
			The same thing, the same way, every time.	A Systems Pack: a 5-step SOP for a key process + a one-month ledger with a savings rate target.
3	19–28	Who does what	Roles are how teams stop arguing about whose job it was.	A Roles Pack: a 4-task RACI chart for a 4-person team + an Ethics Check verdict on three "legal but sketchy" cases.
4	29–36	Run the stand-up	A little less wrong, every week.	A Stand-up Pack: two weeks of Did → Doing → Stuck logs with one documented adjustment, presented in a 5-minute Capstone defense.

The Capstone (the Systems-and-Roles Venture) threads all four units. Students start by mapping a real business, sketch their own customer segment, build the operating system (SOP + ledger), name the roles (RACI + ethics), and prove they can run a weekly stand-up. The end-of-year defense is shorter than Grade 7's (3–4 minutes) — Grade 6 is the warm-up year for middle-school defenses, not the final exam.

Optional pivot windows in Weeks 9, 19, and 29 allow students to switch ventures if evidence demands it. (Most don't. Grade 6 is the year to finish an idea, not to keep starting new ones.)

Vocabulary roadmap (15–20 terms)

"Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken."

— CASH

Vocabulary in Grade 6 is the first year of explicit middle-school terms. Each unit introduces 4–6 new terms; old terms (from Grades 3–5) are recycled. Students keep a Vocabulary Spine in their notebook (a single index list that grows all year) and a Frayer model is built for each "weight-bearing" term.

Unit 1 (value chain and segment vocabulary): supplier, producer, seller, customer, value chain, segment, persona (introduced — full treatment in Grade 7), demographic.

Unit 2 (systems and money vocabulary): Standard Operating Procedure (SOP), step, check, income, expense, ledger, savings rate, percentage (recycled from math).

Unit 3 (roles and ethics vocabulary): Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed, RACI, role, legal-but-sketchy, fully fine, over the line.

Unit 4 (improvement vocabulary): stand-up, Did, Doing, Stuck, root cause, 5 Whys, adjustment.

Total: 18 named terms across the year, plus all Grade 5 terms recycled in context.

Anchor texts

Mix of short readings, video, and case studies. None require purchase; school-friendly substitutes provided.

- A short kid-friendly profile of a small bakery (or any local food business) showing the supplier → producer → seller → customer chain. Provided in program assets.
- Checklist Manifesto (Atul Gawande) — teacher-mediated 1-page summary of why pilots, surgeons, and chefs use checklists. Anchors why SOPs are not bureaucratic — they save lives and businesses.
- A 1-page extract on **the Toyota Andon cord** (kid version) — a worker-pulls-the-cord-when-something's-wrong system. Anchors stand-ups and root cause.
- A short article or video about a famous business mistake that a "5 Whys" investigation would have caught. Provided in assets — anonymized.
- Two side-by-side product or business stories — one fully fine, one legal but sketchy — for the Ethics unit's borderline-case work.
- One Cash video per unit launch + one mid-unit video (8 across the year — see the Video Scripts file).

Project arc — the Systems-and-Roles Venture (Capstone)

Across the year, each student (or pair) develops one venture they can run on paper. A venture can be a real micro-business, a service, an event, a content product, or a not-for-profit. The Capstone has four checkpoints, one per unit:

- **End of Unit 1 (Week 8):** Value Chain + Segment Pack — a value-chain map of a real business plus a segment sketch (3+ things known about the student's own customer segment).
- **End of Unit 2 (Week 18):** Systems Pack — a 5-step SOP for a real process in the student's venture plus a one-month ledger with a savings rate target.
- **End of Unit 3 (Week 28):** Roles Pack — a RACI chart for a 4-task, 4-person team plus an Ethics Check write-up on three sample cases.
- **End of Unit 4 (Week 36):** Stand-up Pack — two weeks of Did/Doing/Stuck logs with one documented adjustment, defended in a 3–4 minute Capstone presentation.

Students choose the venture in Week 2 from a list of "Capstone-friendly" categories (food, tutoring, content, service, repair, events). The bar is purposely lower than Grade 7's: the venture must be runnable on paper. Real-world execution is welcome but not required at this grade.

Assessment philosophy

We assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the standard names?** (Did they actually write five steps with checks? Did they actually compute a savings rate from real-feeling income and expense numbers?)
2. **Did the student think about it?** (Can they explain why an SOP step matters? Can they name a real failure case for their RACI?)

The 4-point rubrics in the Rubric Bank are the spine — primarily Business Plan, Budget Project, Customer Research, and Reflection Writing. Holistic scoring is allowed for Cash-video reflections and quick exit tickets; analytic rubrics are required for the Capstone checkpoints.

Standards alignment (cited verbatim from the Standards Alignment Map)

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** Apply systematic decision making to a medium-term financial goal.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 8:** People who own and run their own business take risks but also have the potential for higher rewards.
- **CCSS-Math 6.RP.A.3:** Use ratio and rate reasoning to solve real-world problems — used in savings-rate goal as a percentage.
- **CCSS-Math 6.SP.B.5:** Summarize numerical data sets in relation to their context — light use in monthly ledger.
- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts — SOP writing.
- **C3 D2.Eco.6.6-8:** Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Negotiation, role clarity (RACI).

Honest gap: RACI and SOPs are operational concepts not specifically named in K-12 standards; we teach them because they're how real teams work.

Differentiation in Grade 6

"Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal."

— CASH

- **ELL.** SOPs are language-rich, low-syntax: students benefit from writing steps in numbered form with one verb per step. Provide sentence frames ("First, **. Then,** . Check that ___."). Allow native-language drafting; require English on the final SOP. The RACI chart is visual; let students explain orally before writing the rationale.
- **IEP/504.** Provide pre-formatted SOP templates with one step per row and a "check" column. Reduce ledger transactions from 30 entries to 15. Allow voice-recorded ethics arguments; transcribe to text later. Permit RACI verbal walk-through with teacher before independent fill-in.
- **Advanced.** Push toward depth — second-order SOPs (the SOP for training someone on the SOP), savings-rate sensitivity (what if income drops 20%?), and a fifth case in the ethics check that the student writes themselves and defends with the trickiest defense.

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **The ledger uses "for a hypothetical 12-year-old."** Never ask students to share their family's actual income, expenses, debts, or savings. The ledger scenario is fictional — the math is real, the numbers are not personal.
- **Roles work surfaces real classroom dynamics.** A RACI exercise can resurface "who's the bossy one" and "who never does anything." Use teacher-assigned teams; rotate roles; coach students on giving each other a clean RACI even when previous group projects went badly.
- **Ethics cases.** The "legal but sketchy" framing is deliberately middle-school: kid-relevant scenarios (taking back a "freebie," reusing classmate work, reselling for a markup). Avoid adult ethics scenarios (substance use, dating, money laundering). Stay in the middle-school lane.
- **Stand-ups can surface struggle.** "Stuck" is supposed to surface real difficulty. Some students will be embarrassed. Normalize: every student shares one Stuck per cycle; the teacher models with their own real Stuck (planning, grading, the printer). The point is the system, not the spotlight.
- **Sample sensitivity flag (must be present):** Ledger work uses fictional 12-year-old scenarios. Never ask students about real family finances. If a student volunteers home-finance details, redirect gently; refer to school counselor if a real concern surfaces.

Materials and tools (year)

- Notebooks (paper or digital) for the Vocabulary Spine and Capstone Journal.
- Sticky notes (3 colors) and chart paper.
- Pre-printed SOP template (provided).
- Pre-printed RACI template (provided).
- One-month ledger template with rows for income, expenses, savings transfer, and a savings-rate calculation (provided).
- Stand-up log template — three columns: Did / Doing / Stuck (provided).
- Access to one Cash short video per unit (8 total across the year).
- Optional: a spreadsheet tool (Google Sheets, Excel for Web, or paper) for the ledger.

Cross-grade hooks (year-before, year-after)

- **Reaches back to Grade 5 — Money, pricing, and profit.** Students arriving from Grade 5 already know that profit equals revenue minus costs and that pricing is a choice. Grade 6 builds on that with the question: "Once you set a price and make a sale — what happens behind the counter? Who restocks? Who counts? Who decides?" The Grade 5 lemonade lab becomes Grade 6's lemonade operation.
- **Reaches forward to Grade 7 — Know your customer.** Grade 6's segment sketch is the warm-up for Grade 7's customer persona. The vocabulary term segment is introduced this year so that persona lands cleanly next year. Likewise, Grade 6's stand-up routine seeds Grade 7's weekly Showcase + Stuck — the same structure, deepened.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You don't need to have run a business to teach this. You do need to be willing to enforce two norms: "the same thing, the same way, every time" (when an SOP is being followed) and "which people, and how do you know?" (when a student says something about their customer). The Cash videos take some pressure off introducing concepts; the lesson plans take the pressure off pacing.

If you're teaching Grade 6 after a colleague has taught Grade 5, the handoff is easy — students already know the concrete-before-abstract norm, and they already know Cash. Your highest-leverage move this year is insisting on the boring step. When a student wants to skip writing the SOP because "it's obvious," coach: "Then writing it should be easy." That instinct — that real businesses write things down — is the year's most durable lesson.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 6

"Don't sell. Show."

— CASH

Cross-grade bridge sharpening

Add to Why this year (open): "You ended last year with a price you defended for a product you sold. This year we look at what was behind that price — the value chain that delivered the product to your customer, the system that produced it, the roles that ran it, and the savings rate that kept the business alive past Saturday."

This makes the Grade 5 → Grade 6 hand-off explicit. The price didn't come from nowhere; it came from a chain.

Multi-class branching scenario — "The cookie business that scaled"

A 3-day branching scenario for Unit 3 (who does what).

- **Day 1.** "Maya runs a cookie business at school after-school. She sells 30 cookies a week at $1.50 each. Cost per cookie: $0.40. Profit: $1.10/cookie × 30 = $33/week. Maya's friend Tomas wants to join. They expand to 100 cookies a week. Profit per week: $110. Sounds great. Then Maya bakes one batch with too much salt and Tomas changes the recipe without telling Maya. The next 50 cookies are different from the first 50. Customers are confused."

Class question: "What broke?" Pair-share. Surface: no SOP, no RACI, no clear owner of "the recipe."

- **Day 2.** Run a RACI exercise. Tasks:

Task	R	A	C	I
Buy supplies				
Mix the dough				
Bake				
Decide if recipe changes				
Sell to customers				
Track money				

Each trio fills the chart for a 2-person team (Maya + Tomas). Surface: who's Accountable for the recipe? If both, neither.

- **Day 3.** Write the SOP. Each trio writes a 5-step SOP for "How we make cookies" with checks at each step. Teacher reviews; surface 3 strong SOPs to the wall.

This scenario practices LTO (RACI), OSO (SOP), MFL (per-batch math). Repeatable with: a babysitting service, a slime-making business, a phone-charging station.

Strand-weight callout

This year's eight strands braid intentionally. **OSO (operations) and LTO (leadership) carry the heaviest load.** BAVC, MFL, CBM get strong support. PSIG, ESL, LRCI get supporting beams. A teacher who feels every strand needs equal time will burn out — protect OSO and LTO; let the others recycle from prior grades.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim)

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** "Apply systematic decision making to a medium-term financial goal."
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 8:** "People who own and run their own business take risks but also have the potential for higher rewards."
- **CCSS-Math 6.RP.A.3:** "Use ratio and rate reasoning to solve real-world problems" — used in savings-rate goal as a percentage.
- **CCSS-Math 6.SP.B.5:** "Summarize numerical data sets in relation to their context" — light use in monthly ledger.
- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** "Write informative/explanatory texts" — SOP writing.
- **C3 D2.Eco.6.6-8:** "Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices."
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Negotiation, role clarity (RACI).
- **Honest gap:** RACI and SOPs are operational concepts not specifically named in K-12 standards; we teach them because theyre how real teams work.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim)

By end of Grade 6, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can map a businesss value chain — supplier → producer → seller → customer — for one real business with at least one example at each stage." - **PSIG:** "I can use the 5 Whys technique on a business problem (e.g., we sold less today) to find a possible root cause, written out." - **MFL:** "I can build a one-month income/expense ledger for a hypothetical 12-year-olds small business with a savings rate goal expressed as a percentage." - **CBM:** "I can identify the customer segment my product serves and describe at least 3 things I know about that segment (age, where they hang out, what they care about)." - **OSO:** "I can write a

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for a 5-step process in my business (e.g., how to take an order) with checks for each step." - **LTO:** "I can fill out a RACI chart (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) for a 4-task project with a 4-person team." - **ESL:** "I can identify whether a business action is legal but sketchy, fully fine, or over the line using 3 example cases, and defend my call." - **LRCI:** "I can run a weekly stand-up review with 3 prompts (Did → Doing → Stuck) for two consecutive weeks and adjust my plan once."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cross-Grade Bridge: Grade 5 ↠ Grade 6 (RECEIVING bridge)

You ended last year with a price for one product. Your teacher will use your Market Day debrief as the spine of this years value-chain work. The price you set came from suppliers, producers, sellers, and customers — a chain you didnt name yet. **This year, we name it.** Map your Grade 5 product backward through suppliers and forward through to customers.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cross-Grade Bridge: Grade 6 ↠ Grade 7 (FORWARD bridge)

You spent this year building systems for the venture you imagined — SOPs, RACI, ledger, weekly stand-up. **Next year, you find out who the venture is actually for.** The Grade 6 SOPs and ledger become the spine; Grade 7 customer evidence is the new layer.

ROUND 2 PATCH — "This year touches 4 strands more lightly" Notice

Round 1 noted that students sometimes feel weight evenly across all 8 strands. In Grade 6, the heaviest strands are **OSO (SOPs/RACI), LTO (RACI/teams), MFL (ledger/savings rate), and PSIG (5 Whys)**. The lighter strands are **BAVC (value chain mapping is one assignment), CBM (segment description is one assignment), ESL (three-tier ethics is one assignment), and LRCI (weekly stand-up is a habit, not a heavy artifact)**. This is by design. Heavier strands prepare for Grade 7s heavy customer focus.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 6)

- **5 Whys extension:** Run a 5 Whys on a public news story about a business failure. (E.g., "Why did the local bookstore close?")

- **SOP extension:** Write an SOP for a non-business process (washing the family car, packing for a sleepover). Discuss whether the SOP discipline transfers.
- **RACI extension:** Run a RACI on a real classroom or family event with the actual people. Discuss what would have to change to fit reality.
- **Ledger extension:** Build a 3-month ledger and identify the trend. Is the savings rate going up or down? Why?

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."

— CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 6 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 6 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist.
The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 2 (Spending & Saving) 8-1	Identify ways to deposit, store, and pay for goods and services.
CCSS-ELA SL.6.1	Engage effectively in collaborative discussions; build on others' ideas.
CASEL Self-Management	Set and monitor goals; manage time.
C3 D2.Eco.4.6-8	Describe the role of competition in the determination of prices and wages.
CASEL Relationship Skills	Establish and maintain healthy relationships; communicate effectively.
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-2	Identify ways that consumers may avoid making poor decisions.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

> *"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."*
>
> — CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Roles That Save Time

Maya runs a small backyard car-wash on Saturdays with three friends. Last weekend, every kid did every job. They washed nine cars in five hours. They argued twice. Two cars came out streaky. Maya's notebook says: "Same kid greeted, soaped, rinsed, and took the money. Bottleneck: the towel-dry. Decision: split into roles."

This week, Maya assigns roles. Greeter, soaper, rinser, dryer, money. They wash twelve cars in five hours. Zero arguments. No streaks. Same humans. Different system.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

> *"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."*
>
> — CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"Most adults run their lives without a system. You won't."

— CASH, GRADE 6